How To Start And Adapt A New Project

Offline-first onboarding for the AEGIS schema-version-2 workflow

Start every agent session by validating and inspecting the effective configuration. Treat policy behavior as explicit configuration, not as an inferred repository convention.

AEGIS adds an offline-first, human-steered engineering workflow to a repository. The template ships explicit unrestricted policy so a new project can inspect and validate its structure before opting into repository restrictions.

1. Prerequisites

Git	Working-tree analysis and delivery context	`git --version`
Python 3.11+	Local CLI and hook implementation	`python --version`
Node.js	Cross-adapter hook launcher	`node --version`

Packaged WAEGIS can register its bundled Python runtime, so a separately installed system Python is not required after registration.

2. Install or Deploy

For a fresh project, copy the AEGIS template or use WAEGIS `new`. For an existing repository, prefer WAEGIS `adopt` so configuration answers, the install manifest, and safety checks are recorded consistently.

The deployed shape includes:

```
AGENTS.md
CLAUDE.md
QWEN.md
.agentic/
  cli/
  documents/
  hooks/
  knowledge/
  requirements/
  runs/
  skills/
  tools/
  components.toml
  workflow.toml
.claude/
.codex/
.opencode/
.pi/
.qwen/
opencode.json
```

`.agentic/.workspace/` is intentionally absent from the payload. It is ignored local state created on demand when a run starts.

3. Use the Project-Local Runner

Windows:

```
.\.agentic\tools\run.ps1 --help
```

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POSIX:

```
bash .agentic/tools/run.sh --help
```

Examples below use `<workflow>` for either wrapper. An installed `aegis` or `python -m aegis` command is also valid when it points at the copied payload.

4. Validate Before Acting

Every agent and operator begins with:

```
<workflow> config validate --json
<workflow> config show --effective --json
```

Report the effective write-access, protected-read/path, scope, secret, gate, coverage, and delivery modes with their active rule counts. Do not continue when `.agentic/workflow.toml` is missing or invalid.

AEGIS repository policy and external platform safety are separate. An unrestricted AEGIS mode never disables a host sandbox, approval, network, operating-system, or organization control.

5. Understand the Shipped Defaults

The template uses schema version 2 and is explicit:

Secrets	`disabled`
Protected paths	`disabled`
Working tree	`unrestricted`
Write access	`unrestricted`
Scope	`unrestricted`
Coverage	`disabled`
Alignment protected scope	`disabled`
Gates	`disabled`
Component baseline	`disabled`
Adoption source changes	`unrestricted`
Delivery hook	`disabled`

Inactive rule collections are empty. These values are deliberate policy, not fallbacks. Structural roots remain explicit and must be adapted to the project.

6. Adapt Repository Structure

Review at least:

```
schema_version = 2

[source]
roots = ["src"]

[tests]
roots = ["tests"]

[requirements]
roots = [".agentic/requirements"]

[documentation]
roots = [".agentic/knowledge/components"]
component_template = ".agentic/knowledge/components/component_template.md"

[traceability]
```

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```
language = "python"
source_extensions = [".py"]
test_file_patterns = ["test_*.py", "*_test.py"]
```

Paths are repository-relative and use `/`. Absolute paths, drive prefixes, empty entries, and `..` segments are invalid. Duplicate normalized paths are also errors.

WAEGIS language proposals help fill structural values. They do not silently enable secrets, protected paths, blockers, scope, write restrictions, coverage, or gates.

7. Opt Into Restrictions Deliberately

Example: test and lint gates

```
[gates]
mode = "enforce"
test = ["python -m pytest -q"]
lint = ["python -m ruff check ."]
```

Example: protected reads and writes

```
[guardrails.protected_paths]
mode = "enforce"
patterns = ["secrets/**", ".env"]
operations = ["read", "write"]
```

Example: enforced coverage

```
[traceability.coverage]
mode = "enforce"
coverable_roots = ["src"]
exclude = ["src/generated/**"]
```

Example: stage-restricted writes

`stage_restricted` requires all standard and adoption stage keys. An empty stage list means read-only. Copy the complete example from `WORKFLOW_CONFIGURATION.md`; do not create a partial stage map.

After every policy edit, rerun `config validate` and `config show --effective`.

8. Start and Select Runs

Start a new run:

```
<workflow> start --kind feature --statement "Add invoice export"
```

The graph is written under `.agentic/runs/<run-id>/`. Only after the graph is saved does AEGIS atomically select it in:

```
.agentic/.workspace/state/current_run
```

Rules:

not permission to guess or edit a graph.

- one worktree owns one local pointer;
- never copy the pointer between worktrees;
- never stage `.agentic/.workspace/`;
- use `--run-id <existing-run-id>` when automation must pin a run; and
- treat `RUN-POINTER-*` and `RUN-ID-NOT-FOUND` errors as state setup guidance,

Example explicit selection:

```
<workflow> status --run-id feature-2026-07-22T120000Z-1a2b3c4d
```

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9. Manage Durable Requirements

Requirements are one current TOML snapshot per UUIDv4-backed ID. They are not Markdown registers and they keep no revision history.

Search before creating:

```
<workflow> requirement list --json
```

Create and use the returned ID:

```
<workflow> requirement create --category functional --priority Must --requirement "Invoice export
writes a CSV file." --rationale "Operators need a portable export." --verification "Inspection:
inspect the exported CSV" --affected-path src/exporter.py
```

Update the same behavioral contract without changing its ID:

```
<workflow> requirement update --id <requirement-id> --affected-path src/exporter.py --linked-test
tests/test_exporter.py::test_csv_export
```

Supplied path/test options replace the complete current set. Use `--clear-affected-paths` or `--clear-linked-tests` for an explicit empty set.

Activate after verification:

```
<workflow> requirement activate --id <requirement-id> --linked-test tests/test_exporter.py::
test_csv_export --verification "Automated test"
```

Traceability, coverage, and impact read these canonical files directly. There is no registry sync, registry audit, or generated traceability cache.

10. Daily Workflow

The standard run stages are:

```
intake -> alignment -> requirement -> check -> implementation -> validation -> delivery
```

At each stage:

- Keep intent, requirements, checks, implementation, and validation separate.
- Record failing check evidence before passing evidence.
- Update component documentation with material component changes.
- Run traceability/coverage according to effective modes.
- Run configured gates when enabled.
- Stop with evidence and exact next options.
- Require explicit human approval before push, PR, merge, or publication.

11. Adapter Checks

- Codex: verify `.codex/config.toml`, `.codex/hooks.json`, and local skills.
- Claude Code: verify `.claude/settings.json`, `CLAUDE.md`, and trust/approvals.
- Pi: trust the project and verify the `.pi` bridge package.
- OpenCode: start at the repository root and use `/workflow-status`.
- Qwen Code: trust the workspace and verify `AGENTS.md` with `/memory show`.

Adapters contain no second AEGIS repository denylist. Their hooks delegate configured decisions to the shared Python implementation.

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12. Troubleshooting

`CONFIG-MISSING`	No readable workflow file	Restore a complete schema-version-2 file.
`CONFIG-INCONSISTENT`	Mode and rules disagree	Follow the reported remediation, then validate again.
`RUN-POINTER-MISSING`	This worktree has no selected run	Start a run or pass `--run-id`.
`RUN-POINTER-STALE`	Selected graph is absent or invalid	Start/select a valid run; do not guess.
`gates run` reports disabled	`gates.mode` is `disabled`	Enable gates and provide complete commands if desired.
Coverage reports a source file	Enforced coverage found no current mapping	Update a requirement `affected_paths`/linked test or approve a legacy waiver.
A hook cannot start Python	Adapter transport has no usable runtime	Set `AEGIS_PYTHON` or register the WAEGIS runtime.

13. Further Reading

- `WORKFLOW_CONFIGURATION.md` - complete schema, modes, and validation rules.
- `POLICY_CONFIGURATION.md` - intrinsic workflow versus repository policy.
- `CLI_API_REFERENCE.md` - command and error contracts.
- `PROMPT_CHEATSHEET.md` - operator-ready prompts.
- `.agentic/requirements/README.md` - requirement snapshot format.

End state: configuration is valid, effective modes are understood, a worktree-local run is selected, and durable requirements live as UUID-backed TOML snapshots.

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